

BY LAWS OF TELUGU ASSOCIATION OF SOUTH JERSEY (TASJ)

PREAMBLE

Recognizing the need for unified action among individuals of Telugu origin residing in the **South Jersey area**, it is hereby resolved that a **not-for-profit organization** be established, known as the **Telugu Association of South Jersey (TASJ)**.

The primary mission of TASJ is to **preserve and promote Telugu heritage**, maintain the identity of the Telugu community, and provide a dedicated forum for **literary, cultural, educational, social, and charitable** engagement among its members.

These **Bylaws** govern the affairs of the **Telugu Association of South Jersey**, a nonprofit organization formed under the **New Jersey Non-Profit Corporation Act** (hereafter referred to as the "**Act**").

ARTICLE 1

OBJECTIVES

To preserve, maintain, and promote Telugu cultural heritage in South Jersey and surrounding areas.

To organize and promote Telugu cultural and literary activities, and to raise awareness about Telugu traditions.

To encourage charitable activities by organizing fundraising events, donation drives, and volunteer programs. To foster community participation through workshops, mentorship programs, and local outreach efforts. To offer training, networking opportunities, and resources to empower future leaders.

To promote health, economic and sports activities

OFFICES

Principal Office

Identify satellite office space/address

Need to establish a postal address – One of the board member address to be published

ARTICLE 2

Membership Types and Benefits

Membership fee is used for TASJ administrative work or needs only.

The Association shall have four categories of members, namely, annual, life, student and life donor members. Either single or family shall be eligible to become an annual or life member. Family membership is defined as husband, wife and their children of 21 years old or less.

Annual & Student membership

- 5% - 10% discount at popular Indian stores and restaurants.
- A free picnic in summer
- Regular notifications of TASJ events
- Discounted tickets for selected TASJ events.
- \$35 – Annual membership (Family)
- \$15 – Students (Individual) – Must provide valid college ID
- No voting rights to Annual and student members

Life membership

- All annual membership benefits
- Run for an executive position in election to serve TASJ
- Voting rights are granted to elect the TASJ Executive Committee for every two fiscal years. The fiscal year begins with the Ugadi event and concludes with the Ugadi event at the end of the second year.
- \$100 – Life membership (Family)

Life donor membership

- All life membership benefits
- Voting rights to elect TASJ board member during the 2 year term
- Run for a board member position through board members election.
- \$5000 – Life donor membership (Family)

Admission of Members and Renewal of Membership: Any individual who supports the objectives of TASJ and agrees to abide by its Constitution and Bylaws may be granted membership in the Association by the Executive Committee or a designated committee responsible for membership matters. The Executive Committee reserves the right to establish and amend application procedures and membership qualifications. To renew membership, a member must submit a renewal application and pay all required fees and dues.

Membership Fees and Dues The Executive Committee, in consultation with and upon approval by the board members, may determine and adjust the annual dues or life membership dues payable to the Association. Any revision in membership dues may occur only once per calendar year and will take effect at the beginning of the subsequent calendar year.

Dues shall be payable annually for annual members and as a one-time payment for life membership. Failure to pay dues within thirty (30) days of the due date will result in the automatic termination of annual membership. Annual membership may be reinstated upon payment of the required dues. -

Voting Rights: Each individual member is entitled to one vote. A family membership, which includes both spouses, is entitled to two votes on each matter presented for voting by the members

Resolution of Disputes: In the event of a dispute between members regarding the activities of the Association, all parties shall act in good faith to resolve the matter amicably. If the dispute cannot be resolved directly, the parties shall jointly select one or more mediators to facilitate the resolution process.

If mediation does not result in a timely resolution, any party may request binding arbitration, as outlined in the New Jersey Civil Practice and Remedies Code, provided that the parties have first met with a mediator.

This provision also applies to disputes concerning the Association's actions related to the sanctioning, suspension, or expulsion of a member. The Executive Committee retains discretion to authorize the use of Association funds for mediation or arbitration in such cases.

Sanction, Suspension, or Termination of Members: The Executive Committee may impose reasonable sanctions, suspend, or expel a member from the Association for good cause, following a formal hearing. Good cause includes failure to fulfill financial obligations to the Association—such as non-payment of fees or dues for 30 days after receiving notice of default—or a material and serious violation of the Association's Articles, Bylaws, rules, or applicable laws. The Executive Committee may delegate authority to a regular or ad hoc committee to conduct hearings, provide recommendations, or take action on its behalf.

No action involving sanctioning, suspension, or expulsion shall be taken against a member without providing adequate notice and an opportunity to be heard. Adequate notice must be delivered in writing at least 30 days before the hearing. However, a shorter notice period may be deemed sufficient if the Executive Committee or its designated committee determines that the urgency of the hearing outweighs any potential prejudice to the member. In such cases, the notice must explicitly state the need for a timely hearing. If sent by mail, the notice shall be delivered via registered or certified mail with a return receipt requested.

A member has the right to legal representation at the hearing. Sanctions, suspension, or expulsion shall be determined by a majority vote of the Executive Committee, or the designated committee present and voting.

Resignation: Any member may resign from the Association by submitting a written resignation to the to **info@tasj.org**, addressed to the Secretary and President. Resignation acceptance should be provided by the president with the consent by the board.

However, resignation does not exempt the member from any outstanding obligations, including unpaid dues, assessments, or other charges accrued before the effective date of resignation.

Reinstatement: A former member may submit a written request to reinstate their membership. The Executive Committee, or a designated committee, may approve reinstatement under reasonable terms deemed appropriate.

Transfer of Membership: Membership in the Association is non-transferable and non-assignable. It automatically terminates upon the dissolution of the Association or the death of a member. Membership is not considered a property right and cannot be transferred posthumously.

In the case of separation or divorce, both original family members (husband and wife) retain their individual membership rights. Either spouse may choose to resign their own membership, but resignation applies solely to the individual and not to both members collectively.

Waiver of Interest in Association Property: All real and personal property, including any improvements made to the property, acquired by the Association shall remain the property of the Association. Members shall have no ownership interest in any specific property of the Association. Each member expressly waives the right to request the partition of any portion of the Association's property.

ARTICLE 3

MEETINGS OF MEMBERS

Annual Meeting: The Executive Committee shall hold at least one annual meeting of the members each year. At this meeting, members shall elect Executive Committee Members (ECMs) or conduct any necessary business. The annual meeting must be held before the end of December 31st of the calendar year. In years when ECM elections are not required, the General Body Meeting may be scheduled at any time during the year.

Special Meetings: Special General Body meetings may be called by the Executive Committee upon the request of either two-thirds of the Executive Committee members or 25% of the voting members.

Executive Meetings: Executive Committee members shall meet on the first Thursday of each month to conduct business and review association activities.

Notice of Meetings: Written or printed notice of any membership meeting, including the annual meeting, shall be sent to all voting members no fewer than fifteen (15) days and no more than forty-five (45) days prior to the meeting date. For family memberships, only one notice per household will be provided.

Actions of Membership: The membership shall strive to act by consensus. However, a majority vote of voting members in good standing, present at a meeting with a quorum, shall be sufficient to constitute official membership action unless a greater vote threshold is required by law or the Association's Bylaws.

Proxies: A voting member may authorize another individual to vote on their behalf by submitting a written proxy for a specific meeting.

Voting by Mail or Online App: The Executive Committee may allow members to vote by mail or by online app either postal or electronic, on matters other than the election of ECMs. Board has complete control to decide on the media of election.

ARTICLE 4

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

Management of the Association: The Executive Committee shall oversee and manage all affairs of the TASJ Association. The Executive Committee shall be accountable to the Board of Directors in accordance with the NJ Non-Profit Corporation Act.

Number, Qualifications, and Tenure of Executive Committee Members (ECMs): The Executive Committee shall consist of seven (7) members, all of whom must be residents of the South Jersey area and members of the Association. ECM elections shall be held biennially at the annual General Body Meeting.

Each ECM shall serve a two-year term. However, an ECM elected as President-Elect at the end of their second term may serve one additional year if they succeed to the presidency. No member may serve more than two consecutive terms as an ECM, even if serving in different positions.

ECM Roles

President: Leads the Executive Committee and oversees all activities.

President-Elect: Assists the President and prepares to assume leadership in the next term.

Vice President: Supports the President and manages specific initiatives.

Secretary: Handles records, meeting minutes, and official communications.

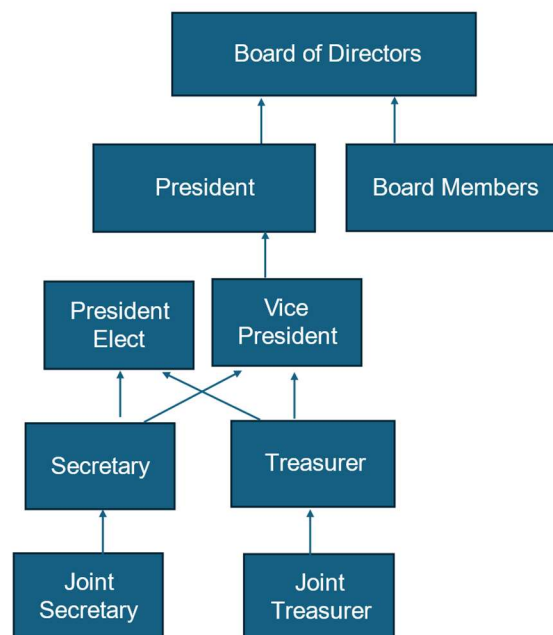
Joint Secretary: Assists secretary in handling records, meeting minutes, and communication

Treasurer: Manages financial transactions, budgets, and reporting.

Joint Treasurer: Assists Treasurer in handling financial transactions, budgets and reporting

Executive Members: Participate in decision-making and assist with committee responsibilities.

ECM Hierarchy



Vacancies: If an Executive Committee Member (ECM) chooses to resign from the Executive Committee (EC), they may do so by submitting a written resignation (via mail or email) to the EC, specifying the effective date of resignation.

The EC shall convene a Special Meeting or address the matter at the next Regularly Scheduled Meeting as soon as reasonably possible, with the resignation listed as an agenda item. The resigning ECM shall be notified of this meeting and offered the opportunity to attend. During the meeting, the EC shall provide the resigning ECM the option to reconsider their resignation. If the ECM confirms their decision, the resignation shall be deemed accepted by the President.

The President shall inform the Board, obtain the Board's consent, and formally acknowledge the resignation.

If a vacancy arises before the completion of an ECM's term, the Board, in consultation with the Election Commission (EC), shall initiate a nomination process to fill the vacant position. During a duly called meeting, the Board shall determine whether to conduct an election to fill the vacancy or to leave the position unfilled, depending on the remaining length of the term.

If the Board elects to fill the vacancy, the EC, at a duly called meeting with quorum, shall review the nominations received and select a new ECM by simple majority to serve for the remainder of the unexpired term. The EC retains the discretion not to fill a vacancy if the unexpired term is less than three months.

Regular Meetings: The Executive Committee may establish regular meetings through a resolution stating the time and place of such meetings.

Special Meetings: Special meetings of the Executive Committee may be called at the request of the President or any five (5) ECMs. The authorized individual(s) calling a special meeting may select any location within the Association's registered area for the meeting.

The person(s) calling the special meeting shall notify the **Secretary** of the necessary details to be included in the meeting notice. The **Secretary** is responsible for distributing the notice to ECMs in accordance with the Bylaws.

Duties of Executive Committee Members: ECMs shall perform their responsibilities in good faith, exercising ordinary care, and acting in a manner they reasonably believe to be in the best interest of the Association. **Ordinary care** refers to the level of diligence that a reasonably prudent individual in a similar position would exercise under similar circumstances.

When fulfilling their duties, ECMs may rely in good faith on information, opinions, reports, or statements—including financial data—provided by:

- Officers and employees of the Association
- Professional advisors or experts such as accountants or legal counsel

Duty to Avoid Improper Distributions: ECMs who vote for or approve improper distributions are jointly and severally liable to the Association for the value of improperly distributed assets if the Association's debts, obligations, or liabilities remain unpaid.

An improper distribution includes:

- Any distribution made while the Association is insolvent (except for corporate debt payments)
- Any distribution that would render the Association insolvent
- Any distribution made during liquidation without ensuring the payment of all known debts, obligations, or liabilities

ECMs present at a committee meeting in which an improper distribution is approved are presumed to have consented unless they provide written dissent.

Liability Protection: ECMs are protected from liability if they acted in **good faith** and exercised **ordinary care** based on the written legal opinion of an attorney representing the Association.

Right to Contribution: ECMs held liable for improper distributions are entitled to contribution from individuals who knowingly accepted or received improper distributions. Contribution shall be proportional to the amount received by each person.

Delegation of Duties: ECMs have the authority to select advisors and delegate specific duties and responsibilities. This includes granting advisors full power to purchase or acquire stocks, bonds, securities, and other investments on behalf of the Association, as well as to sell, transfer, or otherwise dispose of the Association's assets when deemed appropriate.

ECMs bear no liability for actions taken or omitted by an advisor, provided the Executive Committee exercises good faith and ordinary care in selecting the advisor. The Executive Committee retains the discretion to remove or replace an advisor, with or without cause.

Interested ECMs: Contracts or transactions involving ECMs, officers, or members with a financial interest in the matter are not automatically void or voidable for that reason alone. Additionally, such transactions are not invalid solely because the interested party participated in the meeting that approved the contract or transaction, or because their votes were counted in the decision. However, material facts must be disclosed to or known by the committee or relevant decision-making body, and adequate approval must be obtained from disinterested parties to ensure transparency and fairness.

Actions of the Executive Committee: The Executive Committee aims to act by consensus whenever possible. However, decisions shall be determined by a majority vote of ECMs present and voting at a meeting where a quorum is established unless a greater vote threshold is required by law or the Bylaws. An ECM who is present at a meeting but abstains from voting is still considered present and voting for the purpose of determining the Executive Committee's decision. In the event of a tie vote among ECMs, the **President** shall cast an additional vote to break the tie.

Proxies: An ECM may vote by proxy with a written consent or email sent to info@tasj.org

Compensation: ECMs shall not receive salaries or compensation for their services considering this as a non-profit organization and the vow that they have taken to volunteer for the welfare of the society.

Removal of ECM: The Executive Committee may vote to remove an ECM at any time, but only for good cause. Good cause includes unexcused absences from three (3) consecutive Executive Committee meetings.

A meeting to consider an ECM's removal shall be convened following the procedures outlined in the Bylaws. The meeting notice must state that the removal of an ECM is on the agenda and specify the grounds for removal.

The ECM shall have the right to:

- Present evidence at the meeting in defense of their continued membership.
- Be represented by an attorney during and before the meeting.
- Participate in discussions regarding possible resolutions in the mutual interest of the ECM and the Association.

An ECM may be removed by an affirmative vote of fifty-one percent (51%) of the Executive Committee.

ARTICLE 5 – OFFICERS

Officer Positions & Responsibilities

The officers of the Association shall include:

- **President**
- **Vice President**
- **President-Elect**
- **Secretary**
- **Joint Secretary**
- **Treasurer**
- **Joint Treasurer**

The Executive Committee may create additional chair positions, define their authority and responsibilities, and appoint individuals to fill them

Election and Term of Office: Officers shall be elected annually by the new Executive Committee at its first regular meeting following the **GBM**, held on or before **November 30th**.

Each officer shall serve a **two-year** term or until a successor is duly elected. Officers are eligible for re-election but may not serve consecutive terms in the same office.

Upon election, outgoing officers must transfer all original documents, assets, and other relevant Association records to their successors within **fifteen (15) days**.

Removal of ECM: The Executive Committee may remove any elected or appointed officer **only for good cause** with the approval by the board. Removal does not affect any contractual rights the officer may have.

A vacancy in any officer position may be filled by the Board & Executive Committee for the remainder of the unexpired term.

President: The President serves as the **chief executive officer** of the Association, overseeing all business affairs. Responsibilities include:

- Presiding over meetings of the **members** and **Executive Committee**.
- Executing authorized **deeds, mortgages, bonds, contracts**, and other instruments.
- Performing duties as assigned by the **Executive Committee** and outlined in the Bylaws.

The President may not execute instruments on behalf of the Association **if authority is specifically delegated** to another officer or agent.

Vice President: In the President's absence or inability to act, the **President-Elect** assumes the President's duties and powers. The Vice President shall also:

- Assist the President and perform duties as assigned by the Executive Committee.
- Support organizational initiatives and contribute to leadership development

President-Elect: The President-Elect prepares to assume leadership responsibilities in the next term. Under the guidance of the President and other officers, the President-Elect shall:

- Learn organizational processes and procedures.
- Actively participate in **fundraising** and other strategic initiatives.

Upon completion of the **President's two-year term**, the **President-Elect** assumes the role of President.

Treasurer: The Treasurer is responsible for overseeing the Association's financial operations, including:

- Managing all **funds and securities**.
- Receiving payments and issuing receipts.
- Depositing funds in approved **banks, trust companies, or depositories**.
- Writing checks and disbursing funds **up to \$500** independently. Any amount exceeding \$500 requires an additional signature from the President, President-Elect, or Secretary.
- Maintaining **financial books and records**.
- Preparing interim reports for **regular Executive Committee meetings** and a **comprehensive annual report**.
- Providing a financial bond **if required** by the Executive Committee.
- Budgeting for each event
- Ensuring that the majority of the ECMs agree on the spending limits.

Joint Treasurer: The Joint Treasurer assists the Treasurer with all financial responsibilities and assumes Treasurer duties when necessary.

Secretary: The Secretary is responsible for:

- Maintaining official **records, meeting minutes, and communications**.
- Organizing and documenting all Association activities.

Joint Secretary: The Joint Secretary assists the Secretary and assumes the Secretary's responsibilities **in their absence**.

ARTICLE 6

COMMITTEES

Establishment of Committees: The Executive Committee may adopt a resolution to establish one or more committees, delegate specific authority to a committee, and appoint or remove committee members. Each committee shall consist of at least two members and may include individuals who are not members of the Association.

If the Executive Committee delegates any of its authority to a committee, the majority of that committee must be composed of members. The Executive Committee may also set qualifications for committee membership and may delegate to the **President** the authority to appoint and remove members of a committee that does not have delegated Executive Committee authority.

The formation of a committee or delegation of authority does not relieve the Executive Committee or its individual members from responsibilities imposed by the **Bylaws** or applicable law.

Committee Limitations: No committee shall have the authority of the Executive Committee to:

- Amend the **Articles of Association**.
- Adopt a **plan of merger** or **plan of consolidation** with another Association.
- Authorize the **sale, lease, exchange, or mortgage** of all or substantially all Association property and assets.
- Approve the **voluntary dissolution** of the Association.
- Revoke proceedings for voluntary dissolution.
- Adopt a **plan for distributing the Association's assets**.
- Amend, alter, or repeal the **Bylaws**.
- Elect, appoint, or remove a **committee member, officer, or Association member**.
- Approve transactions involving a **conflict of interest**, as defined in **Section 7.04**.
- Take any action beyond the **scope of authority delegated** by the Executive Committee.

Authorization of Specific Committees: There shall be no standing committees. The Executive Committee shall define the activities and scope of authority of any committee by resolution.

Term of Office: Each committee member shall continue serving until a successor is appointed. However, a committee member's term may end earlier if the committee is dissolved or if the member:

- Ceases to qualify,
- Resigns,
- Is removed, or
- Passes away.

Vacancies may be filled through appointments made in the same manner as the original selection. A newly appointed member shall serve the remaining portion of the unexpired term.

Chair and Co-Chair: Each committee shall have a **Chair** and **Co-Chair**, appointed by the **President** with the consent of the **Executive Committee**.

- The **Chair** shall call and preside over committee meetings.
- If the Chair is absent, unable to act, or refuses to act, the **Co-Chair** shall assume their duties with full authority and responsibilities.

Actions of Committees: Committees shall strive for consensus when making decisions. However, a majority vote of committee members present at a meeting with quorum shall be

sufficient to constitute official committee action, unless a higher voting requirement is specified by law or the **Bylaws**.

A committee member who is present but abstains from voting is considered present and voting for determining the committee's decision.

Proxies: Committee members **may not** vote by proxy

Compensation: Committee members **shall not** receive salaries for their services. However, the **Executive Committee** may adopt resolutions to compensate committee members for meeting attendance and reasonable expenses.

A committee member may serve the **Association** in another capacity and receive compensation for those services, provided it is reasonable and aligns with the services performed.

Rules: Each committee may establish its own operational rules, provided they are consistent with the **Bylaws** and any rules set by the **Executive Committee**.

ARTICLE 7

TRANSACTIONS OF THE ASSOCIATION

Contracts: The **Executive Committee** may authorize any officer or agent to enter into contracts or execute instruments on behalf of the **Association**. This authority may apply to a specific agreement or extend to various contracts and transactions.

Deposits

All **Association funds** shall be deposited in banks, trust companies, or depositories selected by the **Executive Committee**.

Gifts: The **Executive Committee** may accept contributions, gifts, bequests, or devises for the **general** or **special** purposes of the **Association**.

Additionally, the **Executive Committee** may approve charitable contributions and gifts, provided they comply with the **Bylaws, Articles of Association, state law**, and federal and state **tax status** requirements.

Potential Conflicts of Interest: The **Association** shall not provide loans to any **ECM** or officer.

A member, ECM, officer, or committee member may conduct business with the **Association**, except where restricted by the **Bylaws, Articles of Association**, and applicable laws.

Transactions with such individuals must:

- Be documented in a legally binding agreement.
- Be in the best interest of the **Association**.
- Include **full disclosure of relevant facts**.
- Receive approval from the **Executive Committee or ECMs**, excluding any individual with a personal interest in the transaction.

The **Association** shall not borrow money or transact business with a member, ECM, officer, or committee member without full transparency and necessary approvals.

Prohibited Acts: As long as the Association remains in existence, no member, officer, or committee member shall engage in any of the following actions unless prior approval is granted by the **Executive Committee or ECMs**:

- Violate the **Bylaws** or any binding obligation of the Association.

- Act with the intent to harm the Association or disrupt its operations.
- Perform actions that would **unnecessarily hinder** or make it impossible to conduct the ordinary business of the Association.
- Receive an **improper personal benefit** from the Association's activities.
- Use **Association assets**, either directly or indirectly, for any purpose other than official business.
- Wrongfully transfer or dispose of **Association property**, including intangible assets such as goodwill.
- Use the Association's **name, trademarks, or trade names** for personal or unauthorized purposes.
- Disclose **confidential information**, trade secrets, or business practices of the Association to unauthorized individuals.

ARTICLE 8

BOOKS AND RECORDS

Required Books and Records: The **Association** shall maintain accurate and complete books and records. These records shall include:

- A file-endorsed copy of all documents submitted to the **Texas Secretary of State**, including but not limited to:
 - Articles of Association
 - Articles of Amendment
 - Restated Articles
 - Articles of Merger or Consolidation
 - Statement of Change of Registered Office or Registered Agent
- A copy of the **Bylaws**, including all amendments.
- Minutes of proceedings from **members, the Executive Committee, and committees** granted authority by the Executive Committee.
- A list of names and addresses of **members, ECMs, officers, and committee members**.
- A **financial statement** showing the Association's assets, liabilities, and net worth for the **seven (7) most recent fiscal years**.
- A **financial statement** outlining the Association's income and expenses for the **seven (7) most recent fiscal years**.
- All **rulings, letters, and documents** concerning the Association's **federal, state, and local tax status**.
- The Association's **federal, state, and local information or income tax returns** for the **seven (7) most recent years**.

Inspection and Copying: Any **member, ECM, officer, or committee member** of the Association has the right to inspect and obtain copies of all books and records required to be maintained under the **Bylaws**.

To request access:

- The individual must have a **proper purpose** related to their role in the Association.
- A **written request** must be submitted.
- Inspection or copying may be conducted personally, through an **attorney**, or via a **duly authorized representative**.

The requested inspection must occur at a **reasonable time** and **no later than thirty (30) working days** after the Association receives a proper request.

Copying Fees: The **Executive Committee** may set reasonable fees for copying Association records, which shall:

- Cover material and labor costs.
- Not exceed **thirty cents (30¢) per page**.

The **Association** must provide requested copies **within thirty (30) working days** of receiving the request.

Audits: Any member has the right to request an audit of the Association's financial records.

Audit procedures:

- The requesting member shall **bear the expense** of the audit unless the membership votes to authorize payment by the **Association**.
- The requested member may select the **accounting firm** to conduct the audit.
- Members **may not request more than one audit per fiscal year** to prevent an undue burden on the Association.

ARTICLE 9

FISCAL YEAR

The **fiscal year** of the **Association** shall begin on **Ugadi Day** and end on **Ugadi** each year.

Non-Profit Purpose: This organization is established exclusively for **charitable, religious, educational, and scientific** purposes. It may also make distributions to organizations that qualify as **exempt under 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code** or corresponding sections of any future federal tax code.

Specific Objectives:

- **Telugu Literacy & Cultural Activism:** Promote Telugu language education and cultural awareness.
- **Telugu Library:** Establish and maintain a resource hub for Telugu literature and heritage.
- **Community Engagement:** Foster understanding and cooperation among Telugu people.
- **Philanthropy & Education:** Support **charitable, educational, and scientific institutions**.
- **Humanitarian Initiatives:** Conduct charitable activities to assist those in need.

Key Areas of Focus:

- Preserve, maintain, and promote **Telugu cultural heritage in South Jersey and surrounding areas**.
- Organize and promote **Telugu cultural, literary, and awareness programs**.
- Encourage **charitable, social, and leadership activities**.
- Support **health, economic development, and sports initiatives**.

Director Election Process

Board of Directors: The **Board of Directors** shall consist of a maximum of five (5) members per term:

- **Three (3) directors elected by donor members.**
- **One (1) director: the immediate past president.**
- **One (1) director nominated by the current executive team, per the Bylaws.**

The Board of Directors serves as the **governing body** of **TASJ**, overseeing the organization's operations and ensuring ethical, legal, and financial integrity.

Board Responsibilities:

1. **Director for Finance** – Identifies funding opportunities, collaborates with donors, secures financial resources, and oversees treasury audits.
2. **Director for Election Process** – Establishes an election team, sets schedules, and executes elections for both the **Executive Committee** and **Board of Directors**.
3. **Director for Public Relations** – Provides guidance on media management, oversees external relations, and manages interactions with public officials in South Jersey.
4. **Director for Membership Growth** – Supports membership recruitment, encourages **Regular and Donor membership** expansion.
5. **Director from Executive Team** – Acts as a **liaison** between the Board and the Executive Committee.

Executive Officers

The following **officers** shall be elected **by members at large**:

- **President**
- **Vice President**
- **President-Elect**
- **Secretary**
- **Joint Secretary**
- **Treasurer**
- **Joint Treasurer**

Committees

The **Executive Committee** holds the authority to:

- Establish **chair** and **co-chair** positions.
- Define the **authority and responsibilities** of committee roles.
- Nominate individuals to fill committee positions.

Election and Term of Office

- The **term length** for both **Board of Directors** and **Executive Officers** is **two (2) years**.
- **Elections for both** shall be conducted in **March** every two years.

Executive Committee Election Announcement:

TASJ Executive Committee Election Announcement (Two Year Term): By the authorization of the **Telugu Association of South Jersey (TASJ)** and in accordance with proposed **Bylaws**, the **TASJ Election Committee** will conduct elections for the **Two-Year Term Executive Committee**. The voting process is kept confidential. **Neither the organizers nor the stakeholders will have access to see who you voted for. We encourage all members to vote. We assure you that the process is fair and secure.**

The newly elected **2025 Executive Committee** will nominate volunteers for various committees, including:

- **Sports**
- **Cultural**
- **IT**
- **Event Management**
- **Sponsorship**
- **Food**
- **Charity**
- **Youth**
- **Women's Initiatives**

- **Membership Growth**

The new team will formally assume charge on **Ugadi event day on the transition year.**

Election Guidelines

- **No individual may contest more than one position.**
- **Only TASJ Lifetime members** are eligible to participate in elections.
- **Annual and Student members are not eligible to participate in elections.**
- **Each family membership is entitled to two votes.**
- **Membership drive can be conducted prior to the Nomination start date. Members who have registered after the nomination start date will not be entitled to cast their vote**
- **Elections will be conducted in between November and December from the prior year of current term ends on Ugadi day.**
- TASJ encourages all members to support and participate in this election process to elect new leadership.

Nominations Requested for Executive Positions (2025-2027 Term)

- **President (2 Year Term) – He will be taking the oath as he was a President-Elect in the prior term**
- **President-Elect – Nomination will be opened**
- **Vice President - Nomination will be opened**
- **Secretary - Nomination will be opened**
- **Treasurer - Nomination will be opened**
- **Joint Secretary - Nomination will be opened**
- **Joint Treasurer - Nomination will be opened**

Election Schedule

Event	Date
Nomination Start	To be determined by the Board and nominated Election Commission
Last Date for Receipt of Nominations	To be determined by the Board and Elect commission
Last Date for Nomination Withdrawals	To be determined by the Board and Elect Commission
Approval/Publication of Nominations	To be determined by the Board and Elect Commission
Election Day	To be determined by the Board and Elect Commission
Counting & Results	Election commission will follow a promine election process complying with the By-L: and share the results
Oath by the New Executive Team	TASJ Ugadi Celebration Day

